Book of Praise User Guide

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1. Introduction

Book of Praise is an application for displaying psalms and hymns as projected slides during a worship service. It shows sheet music one verse at a time, framed in a 16:9 slide format suitable for a projector or large screen.

The application has two display modes:

SVG mode

Shows music generated from LilyPond source files. You can edit the music and lyrics directly in the app.

PNG mode

Shows scanned photographs of sheet music. View only.

2. Installation

2.1. Windows

1. Download the latest `bop-windows.zip` from the releases page.
2. Extract the zip to a folder of your choice.
3. Run `bop.exe` from the extracted folder.

Everything needed to run the application is included in the zip.

2.2. Linux

1. Download the latest `bop-linux.zip` from the releases page.
2. Extract the zip.
3. Make sure GTK4 is installed on your system.
4. Run the `bop` program from the extracted folder.

3. Starting the Application

Double-click `bop.exe` (Windows) or run `./bop` (Linux) to start.

You can also start it from the command line with options to pre-load specific songs:

Option	What it does
`--psalm 42`	Opens with Psalm 42 loaded. Can be used more than once for multiple psalms.
`--hymn 1`	Opens with Hymn 1 loaded. Can be used more than once for multiple hymns.
`--png`	Start in photograph mode instead of the default music notation mode.

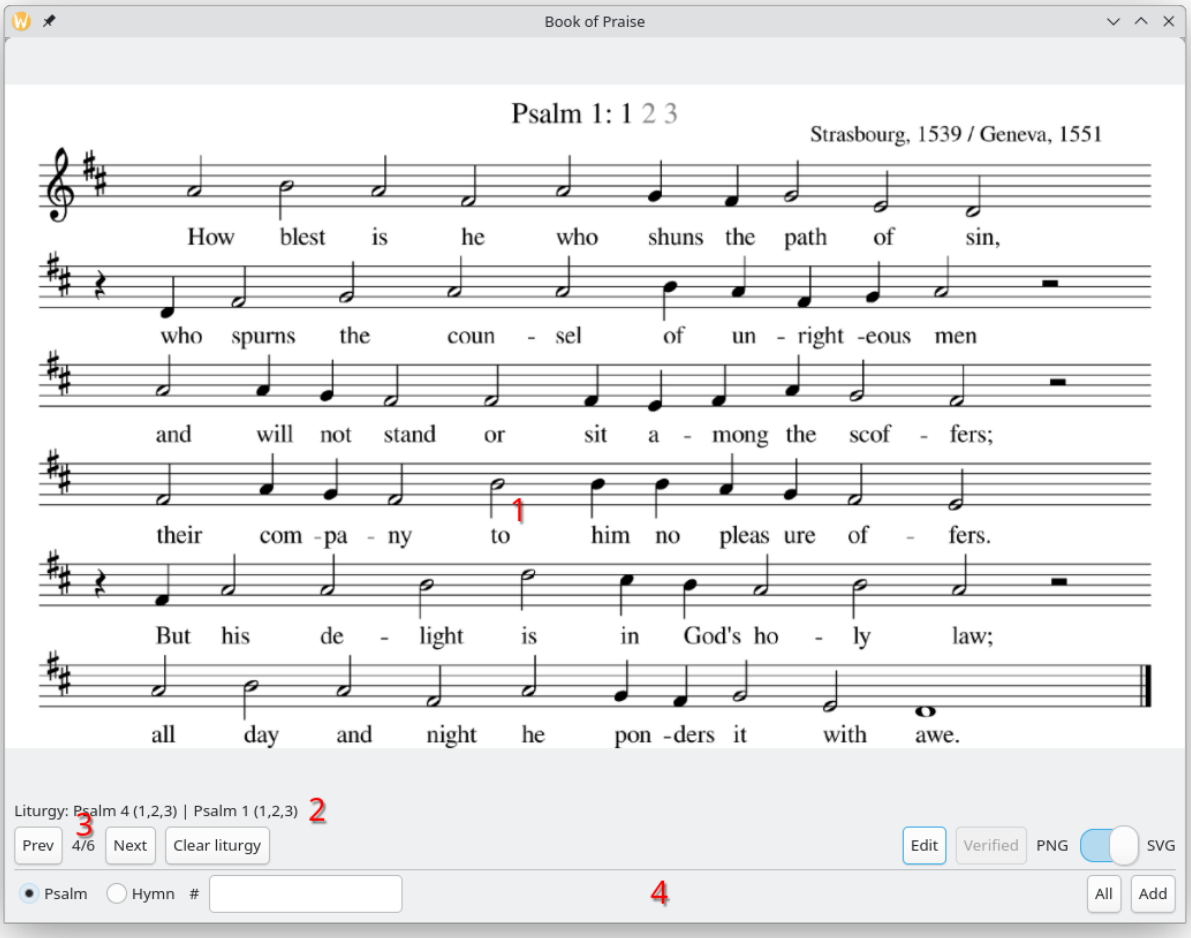
Example: start with Psalm 42 and Hymn 1

```
bop --psalm 42 --hymn 1
```

If you don't specify any songs, the application opens with Psalm 1.

4. Main Window Overview

The screenshot below shows the main window with all controls numbered.



#	Description
1	**Slide display** — The main area showing the current verse as sheet music. The title bar at the top of the slide shows the song name and verse numbers. The current verse number is shown in black; the other verses in grey.
2	**Liturgy summary** — Shows the list of songs you have added for the service (e.g., "Liturgy: Psalm 42 (1,2,3) | Hymn 1 (1,2)").
3	**Navigation and toolbar** — **Prev**/**Next** buttons with a slide counter (e.g., "3/12"), **Clear liturgy** to remove all songs, **Edit** to open the music editor (SVG mode only), **Verify** to mark a verse as checked (SVG mode only), and the **PNG/SVG** toggle switch.
4	**Song input** — Choose **Psalm** or **Hymn**, type a number, tick the verses you want, then click **Add**. Click **All** to select every verse and add it straight away.

5. Navigation

Use the **Prev** and **Next** buttons (3) to move between slides. The counter between them shows which slide you are on (e.g., "3/12").

You can also use the keyboard:

Key	Action
Left arrow	Previous slide
Right arrow	Next slide
Ctrl+S	Save and re-render (when the editor is open)

6. Building a Liturgy

The liturgy is the list of songs and verses for a service. It is shown in the summary bar (2).

6.1. Adding a Song

1. Choose **Psalm** or **Hymn** and type the song number (4).
2. The available verses appear as tick boxes.
3. Tick the verses you want.
4. Click **Add**.

6.2. Adding All Verses

Click **All** (4) to tick every verse and add the song in one step.

6.3. Clearing the Liturgy

Click **Clear liturgy** (3) to remove all songs and start over.

7. SVG / PNG Mode

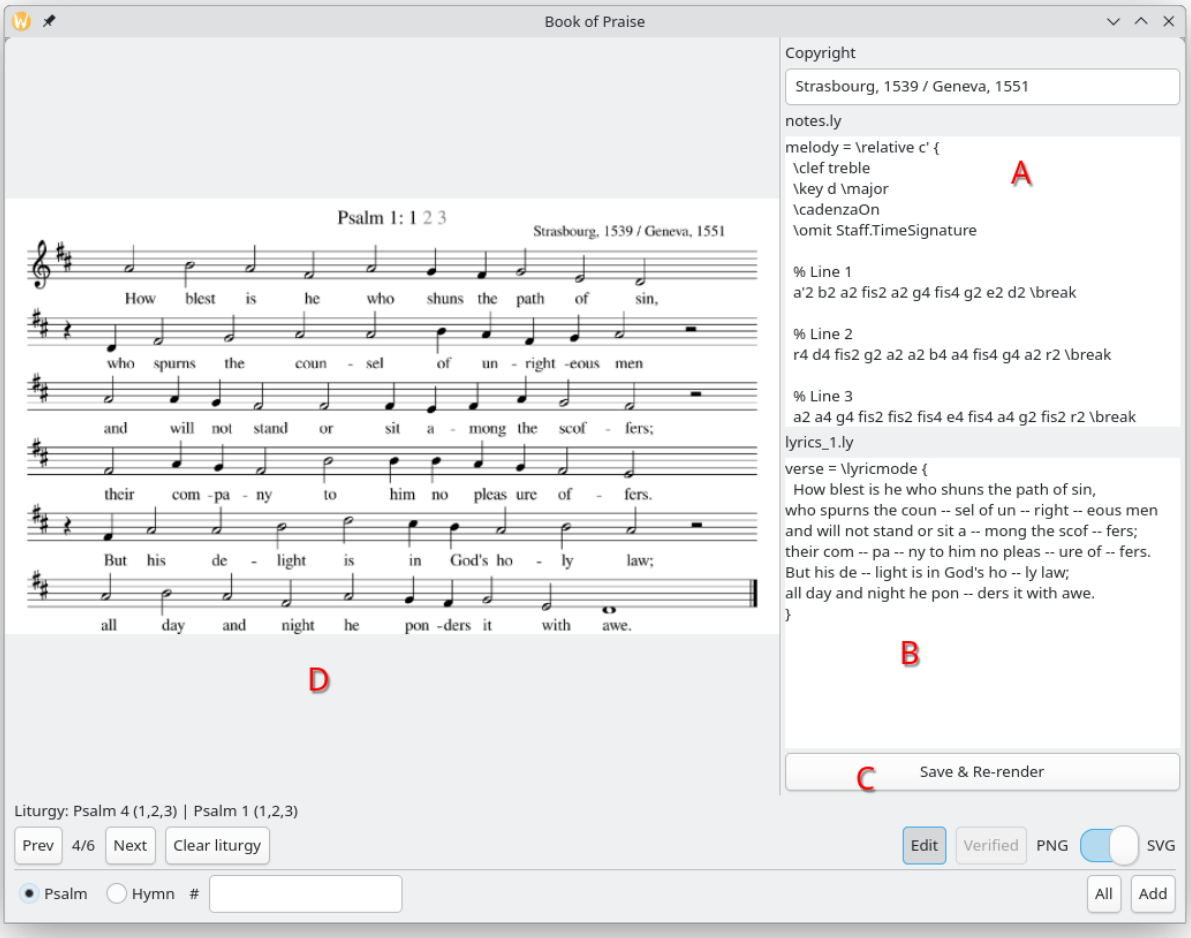
Use the toggle switch (3) to switch between modes.

SVG Music generated from source files. You can edit the music and lyrics. The **Edit** and **Verify** buttons are available.

PNG Scanned photographs of sheet music. View only.

8. Editing Music and Lyrics (SVG Mode)

In SVG mode you can correct the music notation and lyrics directly in the app. Click **Edit** (3) to open the editor panel alongside the slide.



Letter	Description
A	**Notes editor** — The musical notation (notes, time signature, key) shared by all verses of the song.
B	**Lyrics editor** — The words for the current verse. The label above (e.g., `lyrics_2.ly`) shows which verse you are editing.
C	**Save & Re-render** — Saves your changes and regenerates the slide. You can also press **Ctrl+S**.
D	**Slide preview** — Shows the result after rendering. A spinner appears while the slide is being generated. If something goes wrong, an error message appears here.

8.1. Sending Your Edits

When you close the application after making changes, you will be asked whether to email your corrections to the maintainer. This allows your fixes to be included in future updates.

9. Verifying Verses (SVG Mode)

Click **Verify** (3) to mark the current verse as checked and correct.

- You can verify each verse once per session.
- After a verse has been verified twice (across any number of sessions), it shows **Verified** and no further action is needed.

This helps keep track of which verses have been proofread.

10. Automatic Updates

The application checks for updates when it starts.

If a new version is available:

1. A dialog asks whether to download and install the update.
2. If you choose **Yes**, the new song files are downloaded and installed automatically.
3. The song list refreshes with the updated content.

11. Troubleshooting

Blank slide with no error

The music file for that verse may be missing. In SVG mode, make sure the song folder contains the source files for that verse.

Error message on the slide

The music source could not be processed. Click **Edit** to review and correct the files, then click **Save & Re-render**.

Application does not start

On Windows, make sure all files from the zip are in the same folder as `bop.exe`.
On Linux, make sure GTK4 is installed.

No songs appear

Make sure the song data folders (`lilypond/` or `photos/`) are in the same location as the application.